

MAJID MUMTAZ, CIA, ACA, FCCA

Director of Internal Audit & GRC | Audit Committee Secretary

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Executive Profile

Director of Internal Audit & GRC with a Big 4 foundation and 21 years protecting F&B, retail, real-estate, and pre-IPO conglomerates across the GCC — including McDonald's Saudi Arabia, Al-Faisaliah Group, and Kitopi. Currently advising high-growth GCC firms on pre-IPO readiness and regulatory transformation through Veritux Consulting Network. I strengthen operational resilience and reduce revenue leakage by deploying Python/ML-based continuous controls monitoring, recovering AED 7.7M+ and cutting manual audit testing by 80%. I provide Boards and the C-Suite with the confidence to scale by strengthening compliance across complex regulatory landscapes (Companies Law, Food Safety, Civil Defense, UAE Labor Law, KSA Labor Law, WPS, Saudization, PDPL, GDPR).

Core Expertise: Pre-IPO SOX/ICFR | Continuous Controls Monitoring | Python/ML Audit Automation | UAE PDPL & GDPR | GCC Regulatory Compliance | Board Advisory & ERM | SQL & Cloud (AWS/Azure)

Selected Achievements

- **Commercial Recovery & Audit Innovation:** Recovered AED 7.7M+ by deploying a Python/Pandas/SQL continuous controls monitoring framework that automated vendor-testing and reduced manual audit testing by 80%.
- **IPO Readiness & Attestation:** Led the pre-IPO SOX/ICFR readiness program at Kitopi, remediating material weaknesses in 90-day sprints and securing a successful EY readiness attestation.
- **M&A Due Diligence & Risk Mitigation:** Directed due diligence for a USD 127M acquisition, reducing the diligence timeline by 40% and identifying SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure, supporting favorable deal renegotiations.
- **Leadership & Scale:** Built and led high-performing audit teams across multi-sector conglomerates, establishing departmental capabilities in data analytics, cybersecurity oversight, and forensic accounting.
- **Quality Assurance (QAIP):** Achieved the IIA's top "Generally Conforms" rating for the Quality Assurance and Improvement Program during an External Quality Assessment at Al-Faisaliah Group.

Professional Experience

Interim Director of Internal Audit & Risk Advisory

Jul 2025 – Present

Veritux Consulting Network, Dubai, UAE

- **Pre-IPO Scaling & Regulatory Transformation:** Providing interim Director-level leadership to high-growth GCC mid-market firms, steering organizations through IPO readiness programs and strengthening regulatory maturity.
- **Corporate Governance & CMA Compliance:** Partnering with Executive Management to establish Internal Audit Charters and Audit Universes aligned with IIA Standards and Saudi CMA requirements.
- **Predictive Risk Modeling & Revenue Leakage:** Architected a Python/ML risk model for a SAR 500M+ real-estate portfolio that identifies procurement anomalies and supports SAR 3.2M in annual recoveries.
- **Regulatory Resilience & RERA Compliance:** Restructured the internal audit framework for a UAE property developer to strengthen adherence to RERA regulations and reduce operational compliance risk.

Director of Internal Audit & GRC

Jun 2022 – May 2025

Kitopi, Dubai, UAE

- **Pre-IPO SOX/ICFR Attestation:** Directed a comprehensive SOX/ICFR program (COSO 2013) addressing pre-IPO financial scrutiny, culminating in a successful readiness attestation by EY.
- **Audit Committee Governance:** Managed Audit Committee governance, delivering strategic agendas and board packs across 12+ annual sessions to support informed executive decision-making.

- **Continuous Controls & Revenue Recovery:** Championed a data-driven audit culture, deploying an automated Python/Pandas risk engine and continuous auditing framework that drove AED 3.2M in direct recoveries.
- **Cybersecurity & Data Privacy:** Oversaw cybersecurity and ITGC frameworks to strengthen compliance with UAE PDPL, GDPR, and ISO 27001 standards.
- **Departmental Scaling & Leadership:** Built the Internal Audit and IT Security functions from inception, scaling the team to support the IPO roadmap and rapid regional expansion.

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk

Nov 2016 – May 2022

Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC), Riyadh, KSA

- **Strategic Audit Execution:** Partnered with the Board to design a dynamic risk-based audit plan, achieving a 96% completion rate and a 95% management-action closure rate.
- **ERM & Cost Optimization:** Conducted COSO-aligned Enterprise Risk Assessments, leading a restructuring of the Group's insurance portfolio that reduced premiums by 15%.
- **Co-Sourced Audit Management:** Managed a USD 450K co-sourced audit budget, coordinating cybersecurity engagements with PwC and KPMG.
- **Board Advisory & Corporate Restructuring:** Served as an Audit Committee Member for the Restaurant Sector, providing strategic oversight during a major restructuring phase.

Manager, Internal Audit (Function Lead)

Mar 2014 – Oct 2016

McDonald's Saudi Arabia, Riyadh, KSA

- Transitioned the internal audit function from compliance-centric checking to a strategic, risk-advisory approach.
- Executed operational audits across food safety, supply chain, and labor compliance, increasing planned-audit-hour productivity.
- Coordinated third-party risk assessments and corporate compliance mandates with McDonald's Global Corp.

Internal Audit Manager

Apr 2011 – Dec 2013

KPMG, Qatar

- Managed internal audit engagements and risk assessments for enterprise clients including Hepworth (Manufacturing), Al Meera Supermarkets (Retail), and Astad (Development & Project Management).
- Reviewed major infrastructure developments with Astad, including Qatar Railway and the Lusail megaprojects.
- Evaluated supply chain, operational, and financial controls across diverse sectors to identify cost-saving opportunities and compliance gaps.

Assistant Vice President, Internal Audit

Mar 2010 – Apr 2011

BMA Asset Management, Karachi, Pakistan

- Directed the internal audit function for asset management operations, focusing on regulatory compliance, fund operations, and the internal control environment.

Audit Manager (External Audit)

Dec 2004 – Oct 2009

Ernst & Young, Karachi, Pakistan

- Led external audit engagements across a diverse client portfolio, ensuring adherence to IFRS and statutory reporting requirements; assessed internal control frameworks and delivered management letters highlighting control deficiencies and process improvements.

Selected Publications

- **ACCA AB Magazine:** *Automating Fraud Investigations*
- **GRC Report:** *AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability*
- **ACCA AB Magazine:** *Keeping Risk Registers Relevant*
- **IIA Magazine:** *Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags*
- **Corporate Compliance Insights:** *FCPA Programs Are Missing Nuances About How Bribery Works*
- **ConsultancyME:** *The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy*

Core Competencies

- **Operational & Regulatory Resilience:** Companies Law, Food Safety Standards, Civil Defense Regulations, WPS, Saudization.
- **Governance & Board Advisory:** Board reporting and stakeholder management across 12+ annual Audit Committee sessions; ERM framework design with bottom-line impact.
- **Audit Innovation & Tech Governance:** Continuous Controls Monitoring (CCM), Python/ML audit automation, Low-Code Automation (UiPath), and IT General Controls (ITGC) assessments.
- **Audit Methodology:** Risk-based audit planning, fraud investigation, control deficiency remediation, and co-sourced audit management (PwC, KPMG).

Education & Certifications

Education:

- **Fellow Chartered Certified Accountant (FCCA)** – Association of Chartered Certified Accountants (ACCA)
- **Associate Chartered Accountant (ACA)** – Institute of Chartered Accountants in England and Wales (ICAEW)
- **B.Com** – University of Karachi, Pakistan (UK ENIC: Equivalent to ACCA UK Master's Degree)

Certifications:

- Certified Internal Auditor (CIA) – The Institute of Internal Auditors (IIA)
- Governance Risk & Compliance Professional (GRCP) & Analyst (GRCA) – OCEG
- COSO ERM Certificate
- Risk Management – New York Institute of Finance (NYIF)
- Forensic Accounting & Fraud Examination – West Virginia University (WVU)